SOUTHBOROUGH COMMITTEE ON FRANCHISE (1919)

Evidence on the Claims of the Untouchable Classes for Political Franchise

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SECTION I: THE PRINCIPLE OF POLITICAL CITIZENSHIP

The right to political representation belongs to persons as citizens, not to wealth, property, or hereditary status.
It is fundamentally unjust to base the franchise solely upon property taxation, which disenfranchises millions of oppressed p
A government conducted without the consent and direct representation of the Depressed Classes cannot claim democratic le
Social division must be recognized in the electoral system until social equality is established.

SECTION II: SEPARATE ELECTORATES AND EDUCATIONAL EMANCIPATION

The Depressed Classes must be granted separate electorates to ensure genuine legislative representation.
Without statutory representation in the Bombay Legislative Council, public expenditure for educational emancipation and c
We demand political representation as human beings endowed with fundamental rights to personal liberty and social justice